



94 Games coming in 2009



100 Developing in India



104 Mirror's Edge

Digital Leisure

Technology Beyond Work

Lead Feature

Alternate Reality Gaming

Ever wonder what it would be like to be a part of an adventure like Indiana Jones or a story right out of a Ludlum thriller? We all have, right? And so we play hundreds of RPGs and MMOs to experience a little bit of that thrill. But what if you could really be a part of something like that – *really* a part of it?

Siddharth Parwatay

Welcome to the immersive world of Alternate Reality Games (ARG) – a form of gaming that uses the real world as a platform, while involving multiple media and game elements, a powerful storyline that may be affected by participants' ideas or actions, all the while relying on the internet as the central binding medium. ARG is where the line between games and reality starts to blur, mainly as a result of its primary mantra – TINAG (this is not a game). Reminds you of an obscure Michael Douglas movie called *The Game*? Precisely!



MV Sajeev